Databricks LLM Playground

Integrating external models can also be beneficial to data science projects, and this is especially the case for **Large Language Models** (**LLMs**), which may be expensive and resource-intensive to build on your own. However, the LLM landscape is vast and growing, so how do you know which model would be most useful for a given task? Each type of LLM has nuances and strengths, and teams need to be able to test the model outputs to evaluate them for appropriateness for a business problem. This may sound like the start of a complex evaluation process (and indeed it can be!), but fortunately, the LLM Playground in Databricks makes things easier. This feature allows you to interact with supported large language models in a chat-like environment, and is designed for quick testing, prompting, and comparison of various LLMs. The LLM Playground provides a few features to help you select the best model, including:

- **Model evaluation**: Compare foundational or custom model responses side by side to better understand the differences in results.
- **Streaming responses**: View LLM outputs as they are generated in a stream.
- **Parameter tuning**: Easily modify temperature and top_p generation parameters to see how they impact model outputs.
- **Prompt engineering**: Store and iterate on system prompts to identify which prompt generates the best responses to your specific task.

The LLM Playground provides a user interface to test and compare different LLMs. and decide to either use a foundational model or select one to fine-tune for a specific use case. In *Figure 6.4* below, we walk through the Playground UI by testing a prompt with the *Mixtral 8x7B Instruct* model.

Once you have selected a model to test, you can also choose a sample instruction, or system prompt, based on common tasks: Sentiment analysis, unstructured text parsing, summarization, and document Q&A. These pre-built system prompts can be a useful starting point when beginning a specific task.